

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

ASSESSMENT INFORMATION					
Assessment Completion Date					
Certificate Holder Name			Certificate Number		
Post Holder Name			Post Holder Title		
GACA Assessment Team	Assessor 1		Assessor 2		
	Assessor 3		Assessor 4		
Assessor Name			Signature		

ASSESSMENT SUMMARY

EFFECTIVENESS ASSESSMENT RESULTS (ONLY USE FOR EFFECTIVENESS ASSESSMENT)					
	Safety Policy (Weight-20%)	Safety Risk Management (Weight-25%)	Safety Assurance (Weight-30%)	Safety Promotion (Weight-15%)	SMS Documentation and Recordkeeping (Weight-10%)
Number of Effective Indicators (N1, N2, N3, N4, N5)	N1 = (out of 14)	N2 = (out of 6)	N3 = (out of 11)	N4 = (out of 5)	N5 = (out of 3)
Percentage of Effectiveness (Element)	N1/14x100= %	N2/6x100= %	N3/11x100= %	N4/5x100= %	N5/3x100= %
Index of Effective Indicators	N1/14x20= (a)	N2/6x25= (b)	N3/11x30= (c)	N4/5x15= (d)	N5/3x10= (e)
Total Effectiveness Achieved	a + b + c + d + e = % SMS Effectiveness				

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SUBPART B – SAFETY POLICY (Element 1)

SAFETY POLICY (1.1)

1.1.1 There is a safety policy, signed by the Accountable Executive, which includes a commitment to continuous improvement, defines the organisation's safety objectives, and reflects the organisation's commitment to promoting a positive safety culture

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the Safety Policy - Check that the policy is signed by the Accountable Executive - Read the policy and confirm it clearly includes: • A commitment to safety • A commitment to continuous improvement • Clear safety objectives • A commitment to a positive safety culture - Review the wording of the policy and confirm it is: • Clear • Easy to understand • Relevant to the organisation's actual operations - Check the last review date of the policy - Check if a review cycle is defined (for example, every two years) - Confirm that the review cycle is being followed - Verify that the latest version was approved by the Accountable Executive - Speak with the Accountable Executive to see if they can explain the policy in their own words - Confirm that the Accountable Executive shows real commitment to continuous improvement - Look for visible leadership involvement in safety activities - Confirm that the policy is actively used in the organisation, not just kept on file
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (1) & (2) - 5.21 (c) - 5.21 (e)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Safety policy is signed by the Accountable Executive.	The safety policy is easy to read and clearly communicates the organisation's commitment to safety, continuous improvement, safety objectives, and the promotion of a positive safety culture.	The safety policy is reviewed regularly by the Accountable Executive to ensure it remains relevant to the organisation.	The Accountable Executive is familiar with the contents of the safety policy and committed to continuous improvement.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.2 The safety policy includes a statement to provide appropriate SMS resources, and the organisation is managing resources by anticipating and addressing any shortfalls.

Guidance	- Check that the safety policy includes a clear statement about providing SMS resources - Confirm that the policy refers to: • Financial resources • Human resources • Technical resources - Ask how the organisation decides what SMS resources it needs - Look for evidence of a formal process to assess resource needs - Ask how the organisation identifies any shortage in SMS resources - Check how resource gaps are recorded or tracked - Review how resource shortfalls are addressed - Confirm that SMS staff are competent and Sufficient in number - Check that SMS resources are properly established and maintained - Check how the Accountable Executive ensures resources are made available - Look for evidence such as: • SMS budget allocations • Approved SMS positions • Tools and systems used to support SMS - Confirm that resources are: • Planned, not only added after problems occur - Adjusted when the organisation or operations change
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (3)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A clear statement about the provision of the necessary resources for the implementation of the SMS.	There is a process for assessing resources and addressing any shortfalls.	The organisation is assessing and providing the necessary resources for the implementation of the SMS.	Competent and adequate SMS resources are established and sustained. The accountable executive ensures financial, human and technical resources are available to support the implementation of SMS.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.3 There is a means in place for the communication of the safety policy.	
Guidance	- Check how the safety policy is communicated within the organisation - Ask for evidence of communication methods used for the safety policy - Confirm that communication clearly covers: • Responsibilities • Accountability • Authority of the Accountable Executive • Authority of safety personnel - Check that the safety policy is: • Clearly visible to all staff • Displayed at all relevant sites and facilities - Confirm that the policy is: • Easy to understand • Available in the right languages, where needed - Verify that the policy is communicated to: • All employees • Contracted staff - External organisations involved in operations - Confirm that safety policy awareness is: • Widespread across the organisation • Not limited to management only - Look for evidence such as: • Policy briefings • Induction training • Safety meetings • Internal communications • Confirm that communication of the safety policy is ongoing - Not just a one-time activity or operations change
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (b) - 5.21 (d)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a means in place for the communication of the safety policy including responsibilities, accountability, and authority of the accountable executive and safety personnel.	The safety policy is clearly visible to all staff (consider multiple sites). The safety policy is understandable (consider multiple languages).	The safety policy is communicated to all personnel (including relevant contract staff and organisations).	People across the organisation are familiar with the policy and can describe their obligations in respect of the safety policy.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.4 The Accountable Executive and the senior management team promote a positive safety culture and demonstrate their commitment to the safety policy through active and visible participation in the safety management system.

Guidance	- Verify the policy includes a documented commitment to safety - Look for evidence of visible leadership involvement, such as: • Participation in safety meetings • Safety walk-arounds • Safety briefings • Safety campaigns - Look for evidence of: • Leadership engagement with staff on safety • Safety feedback mechanisms • Management response to safety concerns - Ask staff: • If they feel encouraged to report safety issues • If they feel they are treated fairly and justly - Look for evidence that: • Safety is prioritized in management decisions • Safety objectives influence operational decisions - Check for: • Staff participation in safety initiatives • Safety suggestions and improvement actions
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (2)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.4 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The organization commitment to safety is documented within the safety policy.	The policy expresses a strong, visible commitment to fostering a positive safety culture, including principles such as openness, trust, fair and just treatment, encouragement of safety reporting, and shared responsibility.	Safety-related expectations are consistently communicated and reinforced through leadership engagement, team meetings, and feedback mechanisms.	The safety commitment is visibly upheld by leadership and staff, evidenced by increased engagement in safety initiatives, decision-making that prioritises safety, and alignment with the organisation's overall SMS effectiveness.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.5 There is a safety reporting policy that defines requirements for employee reporting of safety hazards or issues and for reporting safety data and issues to the President

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the Safety Reporting Policy - Check that the policy clearly explains: • What employees must report • What safety data and issues must be reported to the President - Review the policy to confirm it clearly states: • Which hazards and safety issues must be reported • What type of safety data must be reported • How reports are submitted • Who is responsible for reporting (employees and management) - Check that the policy aligns with: • The organisation's safety objectives • Safety reporting principles - Speak with employees and managers to confirm: • They know how to submit a safety report • They have used the reporting system before - Confirm that safety reporting is: • Actively used by employees • Actively used by management - Check that safety data and issues are: • Shared with the President • Communicated through clear and defined channels - Look for evidence such as: • Submitted safety reports • Records of escalation to senior management • Safety data shared with the President • Confirm that reporting is timely, accurate and complete - Check that reported safety issues result in: • Management awareness • Decisions being made • Corrective or preventive actions
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (4)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.5 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A documented safety reporting policy exists, outlining reporting requirements for employees and for communication to the President.	The policy clearly defines what hazards, issues, or safety data must be reported, the reporting process, and the responsibilities of employees and management, ensuring alignment with safety objectives.	Employees and management actively follow the reporting policy, submitting safety reports and communicating relevant safety data to the President as required.	The policy effectively ensures timely, accurate, and complete reporting of safety issues, enabling senior management to monitor safety performance, make informed decisions, and take corrective or preventive actions.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.6 A just culture policy and principles have been defined that clearly identifies acceptable and unacceptable behaviours to promote a just culture.

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the Just Culture Policy - Check that the policy clearly defines: • Acceptable behaviours • Unacceptable behaviours • Conditions under which disciplinary action may apply - Confirm that the policy gives clear examples such as: • Illegal activity • Negligence • Wilful misconduct - Check that the policy clearly reflects just culture principles - Confirm that the policy is written in a way that allows it to be applied consistently across the organisation - Look for evidence that the policy is: • Communicated to staff • Reinforced through training or briefings - Speak with staff to confirm: • If they are aware of the just culture policy • If they trust the policy - Look for evidence that the policy is: • Applied fairly • Applied in a consistent way - Look for records or examples such as: • Case reviews • Decisions made in line with the just culture policy • Similar events being treated in a consistent manner
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (5)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.1.6 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a policy that defines unacceptable behaviour and conditions for disciplinary action.	The policy clearly identifies unacceptable behaviours, including the conditions under which punitive action would be considered (e.g. illegal activity, negligence or wilful misconduct). The principles ensure that the policy can be applied consistently across the whole organisation.	There is evidence of the just culture policy and supporting principles being applied and promoted to staff.	The just culture policy is applied in a fair and consistent manner and staff trust the policy. There is evidence that the line between acceptable and unacceptable behaviour has been determined in consultation with staff and staff representatives.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SAFETY ACCOUNTABILITY, AUTHORITY AND RESPONSIBILITIES (1.2)

1.2.1 An Accountable Executive has been appointed with full responsibility and accountability to ensure the SMS is properly implemented and performing effectively.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence of the formal appointment of the Accountable Executive - Confirm that the Accountable Executive has ultimate accountability for the SMS - Check that the Accountable Executive is: • The final authority over operations • In control of financial resources • In control of human resources • Ultimately responsible for safety performance - Check that the Accountable Executive is: • Clearly identified in SMS documents • Named in organisational and governance documents - Confirm that the Accountable Executive's SMS roles and responsibilities are clearly described - Check that the Accountable Executive: • Is fully aware of their SMS duties • Does not pass overall accountability to the Safety Manager - Speak with staff to confirm: • Whether the Accountable Executive is accessible • Whether staff can raise safety issues directly - Look for evidence that the Accountable Executive: • Monitors SMS performance • Reviews SMS performance • Supports SMS improvements - Check for involvement in: • SMS reviews • Safety meetings • Senior management safety discussions - Confirm that SMS performance is: • Tracked at senior leadership level • Linked to management decisions
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.23 (a) (1) - 5.25 (a) (2)(3) & (4)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
An Accountable Executive has been appointed with ultimate accountability for the SMS.	The Accountable Executive is the final authority over operations; controls the financial resources; controls the human resources required for the operations and retains ultimate responsibility for the safety performance of the operations.	The Accountable Executive is fully aware of their SMS roles and responsibilities. The Accountable Executive is accessible to the staff in the organisation.	The Accountable Executive ensures that the performance of the SMS is being monitored, reviewed, and improved.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.2 The Accountable Executive is fully aware of their SMS roles and responsibilities in respect of the safety policy, safety standards, and safety culture of the organisation.	
Guidance	- Check that the Accountable Executive's SMS roles and responsibilities are clearly written and documented - Confirm that these responsibilities clearly include: • Making sure the SMS is implemented across all areas • Making sure the SMS is working effectively • Developing and signing the safety policy • Communicating the safety policy across the organisation • Regularly reviewing the safety policy • Reviewing safety performance • Acting when safety performance is below standard • Making sure accidents and incidents are reported in line with GACAR • Promoting a reporting culture • Supporting voluntary reporting to the President - Check that the Accountable Executive has documented authority to stop operations when safety risk becomes unacceptable - Look for evidence that the Accountable Executive: • Reviews safety performance reports • Approves safety-related actions • Supports SMS improvement initiatives - Check that SMS performance is: • Reviewed at senior management level • Tracked through management review processes - Look for evidence of: • Accountable Executive participation in management meetings • Accountable Executive endorsement of safety communications • Accountable Executive approval of safety resources and actions - Confirm that the Accountable Executive's responsibilities are: • Built into governance documents • Visible in real, day-to-day organisational practice
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.25 (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
An Accountable Executive has been appointed with full responsibility for the SMS.	SMS responsibilities of the Accountable Executive include but not limited to the responsibilities in GACAR 5: 5.25 (b)	The Accountable Executive ensures that the SMS is properly resourced, implemented, and maintained, and has the authority to stop the operation if there is an unacceptable level of safety risk.	The Accountable Executive ensures that the performance of the SMS is being monitored, reviewed, and improved.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.3 Safety accountabilities, authorities, and responsibilities are defined and documented throughout the organisation and staff understand their own responsibilities.

Guidance	- Ask to see documents that show who is responsible for safety and what their authority is - Check that safety responsibilities are defined for: • Managers (excluding the Accountable Executive and Safety Manager) • Supervisors • Operational staff - Review the way responsibilities are written and confirm they are: • Clear • Linked to each role • Not generic or copied - Check that the structure of responsibilities: • Does not overlap between roles • Avoids confusion in who can decide what • Supports clear and practical decision-making - Confirm that safety responsibilities appear in: • Job descriptions • Organizational charts • SMS manuals or procedures - Confirm what happens in day-to-day operations match documented roles and responsibilities - Ask staff to explain what their safety responsibilities are - Look for evidence that: • Line managers are actively using their safety authority • Safety decisions are taken at the right level - Confirm that safety responsibilities are: • Understood across different levels of the organisation • Not limited to management only - Look for signs of: • Strong ownership of safety by staff • Clear lines of safety authority • Safety decisions linked to defined responsibilities
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (d) - 5.23 (a) (2 & 3) - 5.23 (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The safety accountability, authorities, and responsibilities of staff (other than the accountable executive and safety manager) are clearly defined and documented.	The defined accountabilities, authorities and responsibilities are comprehensive, role-specific, and structured in a way that ensures clarity, avoids overlap, and supports consistent application across the organisation.	Staff are aware of and apply their defined safety responsibilities, with accountabilities and authorities actively exercised in daily operations.	The clear definition and consistent application of accountabilities and responsibilities ensure strong ownership of safety at all levels, robust lines of authority, and effective decision-making, thereby reinforcing organisational safety performance and the overall effectiveness of the SMS.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.4 A competent safety manager who is responsible for the implementation and maintenance of the SMS has been appointed with a direct reporting line to the Accountable Executive.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that a Safety Manager has been formally appointed - Confirm that the Safety Manager is: • Responsible for implementing the SMS • Responsible for maintaining the SMS - Check that the Safety Manager has a direct reporting line to the Accountable Executive - Verify that the Safety Manager is Acceptable to the President - Review the Safety Manager's background to confirm they are: • Competent in SMS • Properly qualified • Experienced for the size and complexity of the organisation - Confirm that the Safety Manager is fully aware of their SMS responsibilities - Look for evidence that the Safety Manager implemented and is actively maintaining the SMS - Check that the Safety Manager: • Is in regular communication with the Accountable Executive • Escalates safety issues when needed • Is accessible and approachable to staff on safety matters - Look for evidence that the Safety Manager: • Identifies safety issues and SMS improvements • Acts on improvements in a timely manner - Look for evidence that the Safety Manager: • Is formally involved in safety-related management meetings • Is consulted on major safety decisions • Provides input into risk assessments and safety actions • Has direct access to the Accountable Executive on safety matters • Submits safety performance reports to decision-makers • Has safety recommendations accepted and acted upon - Look for evidence that the Safety Manager is involved in: • Change management • Safety investigations • Safety performance reviews
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.25 (c) - 5.25 (d)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.4 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A safety manager who is responsible for the implementation and maintenance of the SMS has been appointed with a direct reporting line to the Accountable Executive.	The safety manager is competent and fully aware of the SMS responsibilities. The safety Manager is acceptable to the President.	The safety manager has implemented and is maintaining the SMS. The safety manager is in regular communication with the Accountable Executive and escalates safety issues when appropriate. The safety manager is accessible to staff in the organisation.	The safety manager is competent to manage the SMS and identifies improvements in a timely manner. The Safety Manager has direct access to the Accountable Executive, escalates safety issues when needed, and their safety recommendations lead to real actions and improvements.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.5 The organisation has established appropriate safety committee(s) that discuss and address safety risks and compliance issues and includes the Accountable Executive and the heads of functional areas.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that safety committee(s) have been formally established - Check that the safety committee structure: • Supports the SMS across the organisation • Has a clear purpose and scope - Confirm that the scope of the safety committee includes safety risks and compliance issues - Check that the highest-level safety committee includes: • The Accountable Executive • The heads of key functional areas - Review meeting records to confirm: • Meetings are taking place • Attendance is recorded • Safety topics are discussed • Actions are documented - Check that the safety committee: • Monitors SMS effectiveness • Monitors compliance monitoring activities - Look for evidence that the committee reviews whether sufficient resources are available for SMS and compliance - Check that actions raised by the committee are tracked - Confirm that: • Safety objectives and SPIs are reviewed • Safety performance is discussed - Check that safety committees include relevant key stakeholders - Look for evidence that: • Meeting outcomes are documented • Decisions are communicated • Actions are agreed, taken, and followed up in a timely manner - Confirm that: • Safety performance and safety objectives are regularly reviewed • Necessary actions are taken based on the review
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.23 (a) (2) (i, ii & iv) - 5.25 (b) (5)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.2.5 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The organisation has established safety committee(s).	Safety committee(s)' structure and frequency support the SMS functions across the organisation. The scope of the safety committee(s) includes safety risks and compliance issues. The attendance of the highest-level safety committee includes at least the Accountable Executive and the heads of functional areas.	There is evidence of meetings taking place detailing the attendance, discussions, and actions. The safety committee(s) monitor the effectiveness of the SMS and compliance monitoring function by reviewing there are sufficient resources. Actions are being monitored and appropriate safety objectives and SPIs have been established.	Safety committees include key stakeholders. The outcomes of the meetings are documented and communicated, and any actions are agreed, taken, and followed up in a timely manner. The safety performance and safety objectives are reviewed and actioned as appropriate.
How it is achieved	Comments		

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLANNING (1.3)

1.3.1 An appropriate emergency response plan (ERP) has been developed and distributed that defines the procedures, roles, responsibilities, and is periodically tested for the adequacy of the plan and the results reviewed to improve its effectiveness.

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the Emergency Response Plan (ERP) - Check that the ERP is: • Appropriate for the size and complexity of the organisation • Coordinated across relevant departments - Confirm that the ERP clearly defines: • Emergency procedures • Roles and responsibilities • Actions required during emergencies • Responsibilities of different internal and external organisations - Check that key personnel always have easy access to the relevant parts of the ERP - Review how the organisation: • Tests the ERP • Defines the frequency of testing • Defines the testing methods - Check that the ERP includes: • Coordination with external organisations • Coordination with non-aviation organisations, where applicable • Look for evidence that the ERP is reviewed regularly and is updated when needed - Check that ERP tests and exercises are conducted - Look for evidence of: • Exercise records • Drills • Table-top exercises - Check that the organisation: • Reviews the results of ERP tests • Identifies lessons learned - Confirm that: • Improvement actions are raised • Improvement actions are tracked • Improvements are implemented to strengthen the ERP
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (a) (6) - 5.27 (a), (b) (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) & (6)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.3.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A coordinated ERP has been developed and defined which is appropriate to the size and complexity of the certificate holder's organization.	Key personnel always have easy access to the relevant parts of the ERP. The ERP defines the procedures, roles, responsibilities, and actions of the various organisations and key personnel. The frequency and methods for testing the ERP are defined. The coordination with other organisations (including non-aviation organisations) is defined with appropriate means.	The ERP is reviewed and tested to make sure it remains up to date. There is evidence of coordination with other organisations as appropriate.	The results of the ERP review and testing are assessed and actioned to improve its effectiveness.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.3.2 An appropriate family assistance plan has been developed as part of the emergency response plan (ERP), and is periodically tested for the adequacy (Only applicable for commercial air operator certificated under GACAR Part 119 and operating under GACAR Part 121 or Part 135 and aerodrome operators under GACAR Part 139)

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the Family Assistance Plan - Confirm that the plan is formally developed as part of the ERP - Check that the plan explains how the organisation will support: • Families of passengers • Families of crew members - Confirm that the plan clearly addresses: • Timeliness of support • Sensitivity in dealing with families • Dignity and respect • Material support • Psychological, emotional and mental support, as appropriate - Review how the organisation: • Tests the Family Assistance Plan • Defines the testing frequency - Look for evidence that the plan is: • Reviewed periodically • Updated when needed - Check that tests or exercises are conducted - Look for evidence of: • Exercise reports • Drill records • Lessons learned - Confirm that: • Results of reviews and tests are assessed • Improvement actions are identified • Improvements are implemented to strengthen the plan
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.27 (c) (1) (2) & (3)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.3.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Family assistance plan has been developed.	The plan describes how the certificate holder will provide the families of passengers and crew members involved in aircraft accidents with material and spiritual help by complying with the basic principle of timeliness, sensitivity, dignity and respect.	The family assistance plan is ready to be executed, is reviewed and tested to ensures its effectiveness.	The results of the family assistance plan review and testing are assessed and actioned to improve its effectiveness.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SAFETY OBJECTIVES (1.4)

1.4.1 Safety objectives have been established that are consistent with the safety policy and they are communicated throughout the organisation.

Guidance	- Ask for a list of the organisation's safety objectives - Confirm that the safety objectives are: • Clearly established • Consistent with the safety policy - Check that the safety objectives are: • Relevant to the organisation's activities • Meaningful for the type of operation - Confirm that the safety objectives are: • Easy to understand • Written in clear language - Check that the safety objectives are: • Clearly visible to staff • Communicated across the organisation - Review how the safety objectives are: • Communicated to employees • Included in internal communications - Check that the safety objectives are regularly reviewed by the Accountable Executive - Look for evidence that: • Senior management monitors the achievement of safety objectives • Progress against the objectives is tracked - Confirm that actions are taken when objectives are not being met - Check that the organisation's safety objectives are aligned with the State Safety Program (SSP) safety objectives - Look for evidence such as: • Safety performance reports linked to objectives • Management reviews of objective achievement • Decisions taken to improve safety performance
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.29 (a) (b) & (c)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

1.4.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Safety objectives have been established that are consistent with the safety policy and there is a means to communicate them throughout the organisation.	Safety objectives are relevant to the organisation and its activities. Safety objectives are understandable and clearly visible.	Safety objectives are being regularly reviewed by the accountable executive and are communicated throughout the organisation.	Achievement of the safety objectives is being monitored by senior management and action taken to ensure they are being met. Safety objectives are aligned with The State Safety Program (SSP) safety objectives.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SUBPART C – SAFETY RISK MANAGEMENT (ELEMENT 2)

SYSTEM ANALYSIS AND HAZARD IDENTIFICATION (2.1)

2.1.1 There is a process for analysing the organisation's systems and operations to support the identification of hazards

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a process to analyse its systems and operations - Check that the system analysis looks at: • The function and purpose of the system • The operating environment • The main processes and procedures • The personnel involved • The equipment used • The facilities required - Confirm that system analysis is: • Planned • Conducted as part of normal operations - Look for documented evidence such as: • System descriptions • Process maps • Operational flow charts • Change impact assessments - Check that the results of system analysis are: • Recorded • Used as input for hazard identification • Used in safety risk management - Confirm that system analysis: • Supports early detection of hazards • Is not only done after incidents - Look for evidence that: • Lessons learned from analysis are captured • Improvements are fed back into system design or procedures - Confirm that system analysis: • Supports continuous improvement • Influences how operations are designed or changed
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.53 (a) (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.1.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process for analysing the organisation's systems and operations.	The system analysis process considers: - Function and purpose of the system. - System's operating environment. - An outline of the system's processes and procedures. - Personnel, equipment, and facilities required for its operation	System analysis is conducted as planned, with results documented and used as an input for hazard identification and safety risk management.	System analysis reliably supports proactive and predictive hazard detection. Lessons learned from analysis are integrated into future system design or operational procedures, supporting continuous improvement.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.1.2 There is a process that defines how hazards are identified from multiple sources through reactive and proactive methods (internal and external).	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined process for identifying hazards - Check that hazard identification is applied when: • New systems are introduced • Existing systems are changed • Operational procedures are developed or revised • Safety assurance identifies ineffective controls or new risks - Confirm that hazard identification focuses on: • Conditions that could lead to unsafe aircraft operations • Risks linked to aviation equipment, products, and services - Check that the hazard identification process includes: • Internal sources (e.g. reports, audits, investigations) • External sources (e.g. manufacturers, regulators, industry data) • Reactive methods (accidents, incidents, findings) • Proactive methods (risk assessments, system changes, trend analysis) - Confirm that: • Hazards are formally identified and documented • Human factors and organisational factors linked to hazards are also identified. - Ask to see the organisation's hazard register - Check that the hazard register is: • Maintained • Regularly reviewed • Kept up to date - Confirm that hazard identification is ongoing and not limited to past events - Check that: • All key personnel are involved in hazard identification • Relevant external stakeholders are involved where appropriate - Look for evidence that hazards are: • Identified from daily operations • Identified from changes and developments • Identified from the operational environment
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.21 (f) - 5.51 - 5.53 (c) (d)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.1.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process that defines how hazards are identified within the context of the system analysis. The process requires that hazard identification is applied when: - Implementing new systems. - Revising existing systems. - Developing operational procedures. - Hazards are detected or existing risk controls are found ineffective through safety assurance.	Hazard identification is focused on those conditions that could cause or contribute to unsafe operation of aircraft or aviation safety related equipment, product and services. The hazard identification process specifies a wide range of internal and external sources, integrates both proactive and reactive approaches, and ensures hazards relevant to the organisation's operations are consistently captured.	The hazards are identified and documented. Human and organisational factors related to hazards are being identified.	The organisation has a register of the hazards that is maintained and reviewed to ensure it remains up to date. It is continuously and proactively identifying hazards related to its activities and the operational environment and involves all key personnel and appropriate stakeholders including external organisations.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.1.3 There is a process in place to analyse safety data and safety information to look for trends and gain useable management information.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a process to analyse safety data and safety information - Check that the process explains: • How hazards are analysed • How safety risks are evaluated - Confirm that data analysis is used to: • Produce usable safety information • Support safety decision-making - Look for evidence that: • Identified hazards are analysed • Safety data is reviewed on a regular basis - Check that safety information is used to: • Identify trends • Detect emerging safety issues - Look for evidence such as: • Trend reports • Safety dashboards • Statistical summaries • Periodic safety performance reviews - Confirm that the analysis process: • Consistently identifies meaningful trends • Highlights key safety risks - Check that management: • Uses the analysed safety information • Makes safety decisions based on the data - Look for evidence that: • Safety performance improvements are tracked • Decisions based on data lead to measurable safety improvements - Confirm that safety information: • Supports proactive safety management • Is not only used after accidents or incidents
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.55 (a)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.1.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process that defines how to analyse safety risk associated with the hazards identified.	The data analysis process enables gaining useable safety information to identify trends.	Identified hazards are being analysed to gain useable safety information. Safety information is used to identify trends.	The analysis process consistently identifies meaningful trends and safety issues. Management uses the information to make informed decisions, demonstrate measurable improvements in safety performance.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SAFETY RISK ASSESSMENT AND CONTROL (2.2)

2.2.1 There is a process for the assessment of risks associated with identified hazards; this is expressed in terms of likelihood and Severity.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined process to assess safety risks - Check that the risk assessment process: • Uses likelihood and severity • Is clearly documented - Confirm that: • Severity criteria are defined • Likelihood criteria are defined • Both are relevant to the organisation's actual operations - Review examples of completed risk assessments - Check that risk assessments are: • Applied in a consistent way • Based on the same criteria and methodology - Confirm that: • Identified hazards are regularly assessed • Assessments are done in a systematic and timely manner - Look for evidence that: • Risk assessments are reviewed for consistency • Improvements to the risk assessment process are identified - Check that risk assessments are: • Reviewed periodically • Updated when conditions change - Confirm that: • Risk levels are used to support safety decisions • Controls are linked to the assessed risk level
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.55 (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.2.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process for the assessment of safety risks.	Severity and likelihood criteria are clearly defined and fit the service provider's actual circumstances.	Risk analysis and assessments are carried out in a consistent manner based on the defined process.	Hazards are continuously assessed in a systematic and timely manner. Risk analysis and assessments are reviewed for consistency and to identify improvements in the processes. Risk assessments are regularly reviewed to ensure they remain current.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.2.2 There are criteria for evaluating the level of risk the organisation is willing to accept and risk assessments and ratings are appropriately justified.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has defined the level of risk it is willing to accept - Check that: • A risk matrix is in place • Risk acceptability criteria are clearly defined • The matrix is easy to understand and usable - Review examples of completed risk assessments to confirm that: • Risk ratings are justified • Justifications match the defined criteria - Check that the defined risk acceptability: • Is being applied • Is not only written in a manual - Look for evidence that: • Risk acceptability criteria are used in management decisions • Decisions reflect the assessed level of risk - Check that: • Risk acceptability criteria are reviewed regularly • Updates are made when needed - Confirm that: • Senior management has visibility of medium and high risks • Mitigation and controls for these risks are reviewed - Look for evidence that: • Unacceptable risks trigger actions • Risk levels influence operational decisions
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.55 (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.2.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The level of risk the organisation is willing to accept is defined.	The risk matrix and acceptability criteria are clearly defined and usable.	The defined risk acceptability is being applied.	Risk acceptability criteria are used routinely and applied in management decision making processes and are regularly reviewed. Senior management have visibility of medium and high-risk hazards and their mitigation and controls.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.2.3 The organisation has a process in place to make decisions and apply appropriate and effective risk controls.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined process to decide on and apply safety risk controls - Check that risk controls meet applicable regulatory requirements - Confirm that: • Responsibilities for selecting risk controls are defined • Timelines for implementing risk controls are defined - Review examples to confirm that: • Risk is assessed before controls are applied • The organisation checks whether the risk will be acceptable after controls are in place - Look for evidence that: • Risk controls are implemented • Responsibilities are assigned • Timelines are followed - Check that applied risk controls: • Reduce risk to an acceptable level • Are appropriate for the operation - Confirm that risk controls are: • Practical • Sustainable over time • Applied without unnecessary delay - Look for evidence that: • Risk controls are reviewed regularly • Their effectiveness is assessed - Check that human factors are considered when selecting and applying controls - Confirm that: • Senior management has visibility of medium and high-risk controls • Mitigation actions are reviewed at management level - Look for evidence that: • Risk controls influence operational decisions • Control effectiveness leads to further improvement where needed
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.53 (a) - 5.55 (a) (c) (1) (2)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

2.2.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The organisation has a process in place to decide and apply risk controls. The safety risk controls must, at a minimum, comply with the applicable regulatory requirements.	Responsibilities and timelines for determining and accepting the risk controls are defined. Before the safety risk control is implemented, the organisation must evaluate whether the risk will be acceptable with the proposed safety risk control applied.	Appropriate risk controls are being applied to reduce the risk to an acceptable level including timelines and allocation of responsibilities.	Risk controls are practical and sustainable, applied in a timely manner, and regularly reviewed to assess their effectiveness. Risk controls take Human Factors into consideration. Senior management have visibility of medium and high-risk mitigation and controls.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SUBPART D – SAFETY ASSURANCE (ELEMENT 3)

REPORTING SYSTEM AND SAFETY INVESTIGATIONS (3.1)

3.1.1 There is a reporting system to capture errors, hazards, and safety concerns that is simple to use and accessible to all staff.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a safety reporting system in place - Confirm that the system allows for: • Mandatory occurrence reporting • Voluntary reporting • Confidential reporting - Check that there is a procedure that clearly explains: • What must be reported • What can be reported voluntarily • How reports are submitted • How the reporting person is protected - Confirm that the reporting system is: • Simple to use • Easy to access • Available to all staff - Check that confidentiality of reporters is protected - Look for evidence that the reporting system is actively used by personnel - Review how reports are: • Evaluated • Processed • Analysed • Stored - Look for signs of a healthy reporting system, such as: • A reasonable volume of reports • Good quality of information in reports - Check that safety reports are acted on in a timely manner - Speak with personnel to confirm they trust the reporting system and feel confident to report safety concerns - Look for evidence that the reporting system is used to: • Support management decisions • Improve safety continuously • Confirm that the reporting system is also available to third parties, such as partners, suppliers, and contractors
Reference	GACAR 4: 4.1- 4.7 (a) (b) & (d) - 4.49 GACAR 5: 5.71 (a) (7) & (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.1.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a reporting system to capture mandatory occurrences and voluntary reports including confidential reports.	There is a procedure that details mandatory occurrences and voluntary reporting requirements and mechanism, including the provision for protection of reporting person.	The reporting system is being used by personnel. Reports are evaluated, processed, analysed, and stored.	There is a healthy reporting system based on the volume of reporting and the quality of reports received. Safety reports are acted on in a timely manner. Personnel express confidence and trust in the organisations' reporting policy and process. The reporting system is being used to make better management decisions and continuously improve safety. The reporting system is available for third parties to report (partners, suppliers, and contractors).
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.1.2 There is a reporting system that provides appropriate feedback to the reporter and, where appropriate, to the rest of the organisation.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the reporting system includes a feedback function • Check that reports and feedback are stored in a database and are traceable - Review how feedback is provided to: • The individual reporter • The wider organisation, where appropriate - Confirm that the feedback process is: • Clearly defined • Structured • Easy to follow - Look for evidence that: • Reporters receive responses to their reports • Feedback is not left open without response - Check how safety information from reports is: • Shared with staff • Used for awareness and learning - Look for evidence such as: • Reporter feedback records • Safety bulletins • Lessons learned communications • Safety briefings based on reports - Confirm that feedback: • Supports learning • Encourages continued reporting - Look for signs that the feedback process: • Strengthens safety culture • Improves the quality of reporting - Check that: • Follow-up actions are linked to reports • Positive changes in safety performance can be traced to reported issues
Reference	N/A

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.1.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The reporting system includes a feedback system and stored on a database.	The feedback process is structured, clear, and designed to ensure that relevant information is shared with the reporter and, where appropriate, the wider organization.	The feedback process is actively applied, with reporters receiving responses and relevant information communicated to the organization to support awareness and learning.	The feedback process consistently enhances safety culture and organizational learning, demonstrated by improved reporting, actionable follow-ups, and positive changes in safety performance.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.1.3 Investigations are conducted for incidents and accidents, as well as for reports of potential noncompliance with regulatory standards or other safety risk controls established through the organization's safety risk management process

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has documented processes for conducting investigations - Confirm that the investigation process covers: • Incidents • Accidents • Reports of potential noncompliance • Breakdowns in safety risk controls - Check that the investigation process is: • Clearly structured • Comprehensive • Aligned with the organisation's safety risk management process - Review investigation records to confirm that: • Investigations are being conducted • Findings are documented - Check that investigation outcomes are: • Reviewed by accountable management • Used to address safety and compliance issues - Look for evidence that: • Corrective actions are identified • Mitigation actions are assigned - Confirm that: • Risks are reduced as a result of investigations • Safety controls are strengthened where needed - Look for evidence that lessons learned are captured and shared across the organisation - Check that investigations: • Lead to timely actions • Support continuous improvement • Look for signs that investigation outcomes: • Improve safety performance • Strengthen regulatory compliance
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.71 (a) (5) & (6)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.1.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Processes for investigating incidents, accidents, and potential noncompliance are established and documented within the organization.	Investigation processes are structured, comprehensive, and aligned with safety risk management requirements, ensuring they effectively identify safety issues and regulatory gaps.	Investigations are actively conducted, with findings recorded, reviewed by accountable management, and used to address safety deficiencies and compliance issues.	Investigation processes consistently contribute to improved safety performance and regulatory compliance, demonstrated by timely corrective actions, mitigation of risks, and lessons learned being applied across the organization.
How it is achieved	Comments		

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SAFETY PERFORMANCE MONITORING AND ASSESSMENT (3.2)

3.2.1 The organisation is continuously monitoring and assessing its SMS processes to maintain or continuously improve the overall performance of the SMS.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a process to monitor and review the performance of the SMS - Check that the monitoring process uses: • Safety data • Reports • Audits • Safety performance information - Confirm that monitoring and assessment cover Safety policy, Safety risk management Safety assurance and Safety promotion - Check that the monitoring process is structured to identify gaps, weaknesses and areas for improvement - Look for evidence that substandard SMS performance is identified and corrective actions are raised - Confirm that SMS performance is reviewed and evaluated regularly - Confirm that SMS performance is: • Evaluated regularly • Reviewed periodically - Look for evidence such as: • SMS performance reviews • Internal audit results • Management review records - Check that: • Actions are taken based on SMS performance reviews • Improvements are not left open without follow-up - Confirm that: • Improvements from monitoring are implemented • Resources are allocated where needed - Look for evidence that: • Accountable Executive and senior management oversee SMS improvements • Management is involved in tracking improvement actions - Confirm that: • Follow-up is clearly documented • SMS effectiveness improves over time
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.71 (a) (4) - 5.73 (a) (2) - 5.75

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process in place to monitor, evaluate and review the performance and effectiveness of the SMS using the available data and information.	The monitoring and assessment processes cover all SMS components (safety policy, risk management, assurance, and promotion) and are structured to identify gaps, inefficiencies, and opportunities for improvement. The process ensures substandard SMS performance identified are corrected.	There is evidence of the SMS performance is being evaluated and periodically reviewed to support the assessment of its effectiveness and appropriate action being taken.	Identified improvements from monitoring and assessments are acted upon, with clear follow-up, allocation of resources, and oversight by accountable and senior management to enhance SMS effectiveness.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.2 Processes and systems are developed and maintained to acquire data on operations, products, and services to monitor the safety performance of the organization.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has systems and processes to collect safety-related data - Confirm that safety data is collected from: • Operations • Products • Services • The operational environment • Check that the purpose of data collection is to monitor safety performance and track safety trends - Confirm that data collection is planned and clearly defined - Look for evidence that safety data is collected on a regular basis and recorded in a structured way - Check that collected data is: • Reviewed • Analysed • Shared with relevant management - Look for evidence such as: • Safety performance reports • Trend analysis • Dashboards or safety summaries - Confirm that the data is used to: • Monitor current safety performance • Identify emerging safety trends - Check that management: • Uses the safety performance data in decision-making • Reviews safety performance regularly - Look for evidence that: • Actions are taken based on safety performance data • Improvements are tracked over time - Confirm that data collection and monitoring: • Support continuous improvement • Show measurable changes in safety performance
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.71 5.71 (a) (1) & (4)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The organisation has basic processes or systems in place to collect safety-related data from its operations, products, and services.	The data collection process is clearly defined, covers the main sources of safety data, and is appropriate for monitoring the organisation's safety performance.	Safety data is being collected as planned, regularly recorded, reviewed, and shared to support ongoing monitoring of safety performance.	The data systems consistently provide reliable and timely safety performance information that management uses to monitor trends, make informed decisions, and drive continuous safety improvement.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.3 Safety performance indicators (SPIs) linked to the organisation's safety objectives have been defined, promulgated, and are being monitored and analysed for trends.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has defined Safety Performance Indicators (SPIs) - Confirm that the SPIs are: • Linked to the organisation's safety objectives • Relevant to the type of operation - Check that the organisation has: • Safety performance targets • Alert levels or thresholds - Verify that the SPIs, targets, and alert levels are acceptable to the president, where required - Look for evidence that: • Safety performance is being measured using SPIs • Data is collected against each SPI - Check that SPIs are: • Monitored on a regular basis • Analysed for trends - Look for evidence such as: • SPI dashboards • Trend reports • Safety performance reviews - Confirm that the SPIs: • Demonstrate the organisation's safety performance • Show whether risk controls are working - Check that: • SPIs are reviewed periodically • SPIs are updated when needed to remain relevant - Look for evidence that: • When SPIs show weak performance, action is taken • Risk controls are adjusted when found to be ineffective - Confirm that: • SPI results are used in management decision-making • Actions are tracked and followed up
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.73 (c)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process in place to measure the safety performance of the organisation including SPIs and targets linked to the organisation's safety objectives.	Safety performance indicators, targets and alert levels are acceptable to the President.	The safety performance of the organisation is being measured and meaningful SPIs are being continuously monitored and analysed for trends.	SPIs are demonstrating the safety performance of the organisation and the effectiveness of risk controls based on reliable data. SPIs are reviewed and regularly updated to ensure they remain relevant. Where the SPIs indicate that a risk control is ineffective, appropriate action is taken.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.4 Risk mitigations and controls are being verified/audited to confirm they are working and effective.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a process to check whether risk controls are applied and effective - Confirm that the process includes: • Verification of risk controls • Assessment of control effectiveness - Check that the review process includes review by the Accountable Executive, where required - Look for evidence that the organisation: • Evaluates whether safety risk controls are working as intended • Identifies controls that are ineffective - Confirm that the process requires: • Ineffective controls to be reassessed • New hazards or potential hazards to be assessed through the safety risk management process - Review examples to confirm that: • Risk controls are being checked • Effectiveness is being verified - Look for evidence that: • Actions are taken when controls are found to be ineffective • Controls are strengthened or replaced where needed - Confirm that: • Risk controls are reassessed after changes • Risk controls continue to deliver the intended safety outcome - Look for evidence that: • Verification results are documented • Follow-up actions are tracked - Confirm that: • Controls remain effective over time • The service remains safe because of the controls
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.73 (a) (3) & (b)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.4 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is a process in place to assess whether the risk controls are applied and effective. The assessment process includes reviews by the accountable executive.	The process evaluates the effectiveness of established safety risk controls and identifies any ineffective controls. The process specifies that ineffective controls, new hazards, or potential hazards to be assessed under the existing safety risk management process.	Risk controls are being verified to assess whether they are applied and effective.	Ineffective controls, new hazards, or potential hazards are assessed under the existing safety risk management process.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.5 Compliance with safety regulations is ensured by defining and clearly identifying applicable requirements within the organization's manuals and procedures.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a process to ensure compliance with safety regulations - Confirm that applicable regulatory requirements are: • Clearly identified • Documented in manuals and procedures - Check that the compliance review process is: • Structured • Comprehensive • Directly linked to safety regulations - Confirm that: • Responsibilities for compliance are clearly defined • Accountability for compliance is clearly assigned - Look for evidence that the compliance process includes reviews by the Accountable Executive - Check that: • Regular compliance reviews are conducted • Review outcomes are documented - Confirm that review results are used to ensure: • Manuals and procedures are applied in daily operations • Regulatory compliance is maintained in practice - Look for evidence such as: • Internal audit results • Compliance review records • Management review minutes - Confirm that compliance reviews: • Lead to improvements in manuals and procedures • Address gaps identified through audits or inspections - Look for signs of: • Positive audit outcomes • Reduction in regulatory findings • Continuous improvement in compliance performance
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.3 (c) - 5.73 (a) (1)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.5 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A process exists to ensure compliance with safety regulations. Applicable requirements are documented in the organization's manuals and procedures.	The compliance review process is structured, comprehensive, and directly linked to applicable safety regulations. Responsibilities and accountability for ensuring compliance with safety regulations are defined. The compliance process includes reviews by the accountable executive.	Regular reviews with the Accountable Executive are conducted, and the outcomes are used to ensure manuals and procedures are applied in daily operations to maintain compliance with safety regulations.	The review process with the Accountable Executive consistently ensures compliance with safety regulations, demonstrated by documented audit outcomes, resolved findings, and continuous improvement in compliance performance.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.6 Processes and systems are developed and maintained for auditing of operational processes and systems.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has processes and systems in place for auditing • Confirm that the audit processes are formally established and documented - Check that the audit process includes reviews by the Accountable Executive, where required - Confirm that the audit scope covers: • Regulatory compliance • Internal procedures • Safety performance requirements - Check that audit procedures clearly define: • Responsibilities • Audit frequency • Audit methodology • Follow-up actions - Look for evidence that: • Audits are conducted on a regular basis • Audit results are documented - Confirm that audit results are: • Reviewed by accountable management • Used to support compliance and improvement - Look for evidence that: • Findings are addressed • Corrective actions are raised • Actions are tracked to closure - Confirm that the audit system: • Identifies weaknesses in operations • Drives improvements in performance - Look for signs of: • Improved operational compliance • Better audit outcomes over time • Positive oversight results
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.71 (a) (3)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.6 Evaluation.			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Processes and systems for internal auditing of operational processes, including those performed by contractors, are established and documented within the organization. The process includes review with accountable executive.	The scope includes compliance with regulations, internal procedures, and safety performance requirements. The scope also includes Audit procedures define responsibilities, frequency, methodology, and follow-up actions.	Auditing processes and systems are actively applied, with audits regularly conducted and results reviewed with accountable executive to ensure compliance and improvement.	The auditing processes and systems consistently ensure operational compliance, demonstrated by effective identification and resolution of issues, enhanced operational performance, and positive oversight outcomes.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.7 Processes are developed and maintained to analyse data acquired from operational processes, products, services, and any other relevant sources to monitor and improve organizational safety performance.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has defined processes to analyse operational and safety-related data - Confirm that data analysis covers: • Operational processes • Products • Services • Any other relevant safety data sources - Check that the analysis process is: • Clearly documented • Structured • Aligned with safety objectives • Aligned with regulatory requirements - Confirm that data used for analysis comes from: • Continuous monitoring • Periodic monitoring • Audits • SMS evaluations • Investigations • Confidential employee reporting - Look for evidence that the analysis process identifies new hazards, emerging safety issues and concerns - Check that identified hazards are assessed using the risk management process - Look for evidence that: • Operational and safety data are reviewed regularly • Trends are identified • Key findings are documented - Confirm that analysis results are discussed with management - Confirm that data analysis supports continuous improvement and leads to measurable improvements in safety performance
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.71 (a) (4) & (b) - 5.73 (a) (5)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.2.7 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Processes for analysing operational and safety-related data are established and documented within the organization.	The analysis processes are structured, comprehensive, and aligned with organizational safety objectives and regulatory requirements, covering continuous and periodic monitoring, audits, SMS evaluations, investigations, and confidential employee reporting to ensure effective oversight and improvement. The analysis process identifies new hazards or safety issues and concerns.	Data analysis processes are actively applied, with operational and safety data regularly reviewed, trends identified, and findings discussed with accountable management. Identified hazards are being assessed by applying risk management process.	The data analysis processes consistently lead to actionable insights, supporting continuous improvement, risk mitigation, and measurable enhancement of safety performance.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

MANAGEMENT OF CHANGE (3.3)

3.3.1 The organisation has a process to identify whether changes have an impact on safety and to manage any identified risks in accordance with existing safety risk management processes.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined change management process - Confirm that the process is used to: • Identify whether changes affect safety • Manage any safety risks linked to changes - Check that the change management process: • Is documented • Is linked to the safety risk management process - Confirm that the process includes: • Review involving the Accountable Executive, where required - Check that: • Triggers for change management are clearly defined - Confirm that the process applies to: • Operational changes • Organisational changes • Business-related changes • Changes involving other departments or external organisations - Check that the process: • Is integrated with safety risk management • Is integrated with safety assurance - Confirm that: • Responsibilities for managing change are clearly defined • Timelines for change actions are defined	- Look for evidence that: • Hazards are identified before changes are implemented • Risk assessments are conducted before approval • Risk controls are put in place before the change is made - Confirm that: • Major changes with system-wide impact are acceptable to the President, where required - Check that the change management process: • Is applied to all changes that may affect safety • Includes Human Factors considerations • Considers the combined impact of multiple changes - Look for evidence that: • The process is used consistently • Changes are planned and managed in a timely way - Confirm that: • Follow-up actions are carried out after the change • The change was implemented safely - Check that: • Changes are communicated to affected personnel - Look for evidence that: • Risk controls linked to changes are achieving the intended effect • Mitigation actions remain effective after implementation
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.57 - 5.71 (a) (2) - 5.73 (a) (4) - 5.74	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

3.3.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
The organisation has established a change management process to identify whether changes have an impact on safety and to manage any identified risks in accordance with existing safety risk management processes. The process includes review with accountable executive.	Triggers for the change management process are defined. The process also considers business related changes and interfaces with other organisations/departments. The process is integrated with the risk management and safety assurance processes. Responsibilities and timelines are defined.	The change management process is being used and includes hazard identification and risk assessments with appropriate risk controls being put in place before a decision to make the change is taken. Safety assessment associated with major change, or a change which will influence other organizations in the aviation system is acceptable by the president.	The change management process is used for all changes that may impact safety, including Human Factors issues, and considers the accumulation of multiple changes. It is initiated in a planned, timely, and consistent manner and includes follow up action that ensures the change was implemented safely. The change is communicated to those affected. Risk control and mitigation strategies associated with changes are achieving the planned effect.
How it is achieved	Comments		

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SUBPART E – SAFETY PROMOTION (ELEMENT 4)

COMPETENCIES AND TRAINING (4.1)

4.1.1 There is a training programme for SMS in place that includes initial and recurrent training. The training covers individual safety duties (including roles, responsibilities, and accountabilities) and how the organisation's SMS operates.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that a documented SMS training and competency programme is: • Established • Approved • Controlled within the SMS documentation. - Confirm that personnel with safety responsibilities are identified and training requirements are defined according to roles, responsibilities, and level of accountability. - Check that initial and recurrent SMS training are established, including induction training for new personnel. - Verify that training content, as appropriate to the role, covers: • Safety policy and objectives • Individual safety responsibilities • Hazard identification • Occurrence reporting • Safety risk management principles • Just culture • Human factors • Safety assurance processes	- Look for evidence that: • Training is delivered as planned • Trainers are competent • Materials are current • Attendance and training records are maintained and retained - Confirm that learning objectives are defined and that knowledge and role-specific competencies are assessed where required. - Check that identified competency gaps are addressed and corrective actions are implemented. - Verify that the training programme is periodically reviewed and updated to reflect organisational changes, regulatory updates, safety trends, and lessons learned.
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.91 – 5.103 (c)	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
There is an SMS training programme in place that includes initial and recurrent training as necessary.	All staff requiring training are identified. The training covers individual safety duties (including roles, responsibilities, and accountabilities).	The SMS training programme is delivering appropriate training to the different staff in the organisation and training records are kept and are up to date. Training records are kept for a minimum of 5 years after completion of the training.	SMS training is evaluated for all aspects (learning objectives, content, teaching methods and styles, tests, etc.) and is linked to the competency assessment. Training is routinely reviewed to take feedback from different sources into consideration.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.2 There is a process in place to measure the effectiveness of training and to take appropriate action to improve subsequent training.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined process to measure the effectiveness of training - Check that the methods used to measure training effectiveness including: • Staff feedback • Testing or examinations • Observation on the job • Performance evaluations - Confirm that the methods used are: • Clearly defined • Reliable • Able to identify training gaps - Look for evidence that: • Training effectiveness is actively measured • Results are reviewed - Check that: • Actions are taken based on training results • Improvements are made to future training programmes - Look for evidence that: • Training gaps are addressed • Training content is updated where needed - Confirm that training leads to: • Better staff competence • Improved application of knowledge in daily operations - Look for signs that: • Training improvements are linked to safety performance • Safety outcomes improve following training updates - Confirm that the training effectiveness process: • Supports continuous improvement • Is applied consistently across the organisation
Reference	N/A

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A process exists to measure the effectiveness of training provided within the organization.	The process for measuring training effectiveness includes clear methods (e.g., feedback, testing, observation, performance evaluation) that ensure results are reliable and can be used to identify training gaps and improvement needs.	Training effectiveness is actively measured, with results reviewed and appropriate actions taken to improve future training programs.	The process consistently improves training outcomes, demonstrated by enhanced staff competence, better application of training in operations, and measurable improvements in safety performance.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.3 Training includes human and organisational factors including just culture and non-technical skills with the intent of reducing human error.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation provides training on human and organisational factors - Check that the training includes just culture principles and human factor skills - Check that the training content: • Is clearly documented • Is relevant to reducing human error - Look for evidence that: • This training is delivered regularly • Different operational roles are included - Check that staff: • Understand just culture principles • Apply non-technical skills in daily operations - Observe during operations or interviews for signs that: • Communication and teamwork support safe operations • Decisions are made with safety in mind - Look for evidence that: • Human error trends are monitored • Training updates are linked to identified human factor issues - Confirm that the training supports: • Stronger safety culture • Reduced human error • Improved safety behaviour - Look for signs that: • Safety performance improves following this training • Staff provide positive feedback on the training
Reference	N/A

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Training on human and organizational factors, just culture, and non-technical skills is established and documented within the organization.	The training content explicitly addresses human and organizational factors, just culture principles, and non-technical skills (e.g., communication, teamwork, decision-making), ensuring relevance for reducing human error.	Training on human and organizational factors is regularly delivered, and personnel apply just culture principles and non-technical skills in daily operations.	The training contributes to measurable improvements in safety performance, demonstrated by reduced human errors, stronger safety culture, and positive feedback from operational staff.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.4 There is a process that evaluates the individual's competence and takes appropriate remedial action when necessary.	
Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has a defined competency framework - Confirm that the framework covers: • All personnel involved in safety-related activities • Roles that affect the organisation's safety performance - Check that the organisation has a process to assess personnel competence - Confirm that competence is: • Assessed periodically • Compared against the defined competency framework - Look for evidence that: • Competence assessments are carried out • Assessment results are recorded - Check how the organisation: • Identifies weaknesses in competence • Determines when remedial action is needed - Confirm that: • Appropriate remedial actions are taken when gaps are identified - Remedial actions may include: • Additional training • Coaching • Supervision • Re-assessment - Check that competence assessments: • Feed into the training programme • Influence future training planning - Look for evidence that: • The competence assessment process is reviewed • Improvements are made to the process when needed - Confirm that competence management: • Supports safe operations • Reduces the risk of errors linked to lack of skill or knowledge
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.91

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.1.4 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Competency framework is defined for all personnel necessary resources for the implementation of the SMS, including Employees relative to the certificate holder's safety performance.	There is a process in place to periodically assess the actual competency of personnel against the framework.	There is evidence of the process being used and being recorded.	The competence assessment programme and process are routinely reviewed and improved. The competence assessment takes appropriate remedial action when necessary and feeds into the training programme.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SAFETY COMMUNICATION (4.2)

4.2.1 The organisation has established and maintained communication processes to ensure all personnel are aware of the SMS, to convey safety-critical information, and to explain the rationale for safety actions and procedural changes.

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has documented processes for communicating SMS and safety-critical information - Check that communication processes ensure that: • All personnel are aware of the SMS • Safety-critical information is shared when needed - Confirm that communication explains: • Why specific safety actions are taken • Why safety procedures are introduced or changed - Check that communication covers: • Safety policy and safety objectives • SMS requirements related to operations - Confirm that communication includes: - Accountability, responsibilities, and authorities of: • The Accountable Executive • Safety personnel - Check that communication clearly covers: • SMS processes • SMS procedures - Look for evidence that: • Safety communication is actively implemented - Personnel are regularly informed about: • SMS matters • Safety-critical issues • Actions taken • Reasons for procedural changes - Confirm that communication is consistent, clear and understood by personnel - Look for signs that communication: • Supports informed decision-making • Encourages safe behaviours • Strengthens overall SMS effectiveness
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.93

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

4.2.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Documented communication processes exist to deliver SMS-related and safety-critical information to personnel.	Communication processes ensure that: - All personnel are aware of the SMS; - Safety critical information is conveyed as necessary; - Why particular safety actions are taken is explained - Why safety procedures are introduced or changed are explained. - Safety policy and objectives are communicated - SMS requirements for its operations are communicated - Accountability, responsibilities, and authorities of accountable executive and safety personnel for SMS processes and procedures are communicated - SMS processes and procedures are communicated	Safety communication is actively implemented, with personnel regularly informed about SMS, critical issues, actions taken, and reasons for procedural changes.	Communication is robust, consistent, and comprehensive, ensuring that safety information reaches all intended audiences, is understood, and supports the overall effectiveness of the SMS by enabling informed decision-making and safe behaviours.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

SUBPART F – SMS DOCUMENTATION AND RECORDKEEPING (ELEMENT 5)

SMS DOCUMENTATION, RECORDS AND IMPLEMENTATION PLAN (5.1)

5.1.1 The organisation has developed and maintains SMS documentation that includes the safety policy and objectives, operational SMS requirements, defined accountabilities and responsibilities of the accountable executive and safety personnel, as well as the SMS processes and procedures

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has documented SMS manuals or SMS documentation - Confirm that the SMS documentation includes: • Safety policy • Safety objectives • Operational SMS requirements • Accountabilities and responsibilities of the Accountable Executive • Accountabilities and responsibilities of safety personnel • SMS processes and procedures - Review the documentation to confirm that: • Roles and responsibilities are clearly defined • Processes and procedures are clearly explained - Check that SMS documentation is actively maintained and kept up to date - Look for evidence that: • Updates to SMS documents are controlled • Changes are approved - Confirm that SMS documentation is: • Accessible to relevant personnel • Available where and when needed - Check that: • Updates are communicated to staff • Staff are aware of changes to SMS documents - Look for evidence that SMS documentation: • Is complete • Is accurate • Supports consistent application of the SMS - Confirm that the documentation: • Supports clear understanding of roles and processes • Contributes to the overall effectiveness of the SMS
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.101

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

5.1.1 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
SMS documentation exists and addresses safety policy, objectives, SMS requirements, accountabilities, and processes.	The documentation specifically details the organisation's safety policy, objectives, operational SMS requirements, and the defined accountabilities and responsibilities of both the accountable executive and safety personnel, ensuring that SMS processes and procedures are described in a clear and practical manner.	SMS documentation is actively maintained, kept current, and made accessible to relevant personnel, with updates communicated effectively.	SMS documentation is complete, accurate, and robust, ensuring clarity of roles, responsibilities, and processes, thereby supporting consistent application and enhancing the overall effectiveness of the SMS.
How it is achieved		Comments	

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

5.1.2 The organisation maintains records of safety risk management outputs, safety assurance outputs, SMS-related training, and safety communications in line with regulatory requirements and retention periods

Guidance	- Ask for evidence that the organisation has recordkeeping processes for SMS-related activities - Confirm that records are maintained for: • Safety risk management outputs • Safety assurance outputs • SMS-related training • Safety communications - Check that the recordkeeping system: • Defines retention periods • Aligns with regulatory retention requirements - Confirm that retention rules cover: • Records kept as long as risk controls remain relevant • Records kept for the minimum required regulatory period (e.g. 5 years) - Check that records are: • Accessible • Traceable • Protected from loss or unauthorised access - Check that regular reviews are carried out to confirm records remain available and accurate - Look for evidence that records are complete, accurate and up to date - Confirm that records can be: • Retrieved easily when needed • Provided to support audits and inspections - Look for evidence that records support: • Demonstrating regulatory compliance • Tracking safety performance over time • Supporting management decision-making - Confirm that recordkeeping: • Supports continuous improvement of the SMS • Provides reliable evidence for safety decisions
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.103 (d)

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

5.1.2 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
Recordkeeping processes exist for safety risk management, safety assurance, training, and safety communications.	The recordkeeping system specifies retention periods (e.g., if controls are relevant, or minimum 5 years as required) and ensures that records are accessible, traceable, and aligned with regulatory obligations.	Records are actively maintained, updated, and stored according to retention requirements, with regular reviews confirming their availability and accuracy.	Records are complete, accurate, and readily retrievable, enabling the organisation to demonstrate compliance, track safety performance over time, and provide reliable evidence to support decision-making and continuous improvement of the SMS.
How it is achieved			Comments

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

5.1.3 The accountable executive has established a documented SMS implementation plan to ensure effective SMS implementation, including procedures for coordination with external organizations or contractors where applicable

Guidance	- Ask for a copy of the documented SMS implementation plan • Confirm that the plan is formally approved by the Accountable Executive - Check that the implementation plan clearly defines: • Steps for SMS rollout • Key milestones • Roles and responsibilities • Timelines for implementation - Confirm that the plan includes: • Procedures for coordination with external organisations • Procedures for coordination with contractors, where applicable - Check that the implementation plan is: • Practical • Aligned with the organisation's objectives - Look for evidence that the plan is actively used and is not a one-time document - Confirm that the plan is: • Reviewed regularly • Updated when needed - Check that: • Relevant internal stakeholders are involved in implementation • External parties are coordinated with where required - Look for evidence of: • Implementation tracking • Progress reviews • Follow-up actions - Confirm that the implementation plan: • Supports effective deployment of the SMS • Improves coordination with external parties - Look for signs that SMS processes and performance are improving because of the plan
Reference	GACAR 5: 5.105

SMS EFFECTIVENESS CHECKLIST

5.1.3 Evaluation			
☐ Present	☐ Suitable	☐ Operating	☐ Effective
A documented SMS implementation plan exists and is approved by the accountable executive.	The implementation plan clearly defines steps for SMS rollout, roles and responsibilities, timelines, and coordination procedures with external organizations or contractors, ensuring it is practical and aligned with organisational objectives.	The SMS implementation plan is actively used, regularly reviewed, and applied in coordination with relevant internal and external stakeholders.	The implementation plan is comprehensive and actionable, enabling successful SMS deployment, effective collaboration with external parties, and demonstrable improvements in SMS processes and performance.
How it is achieved		Comments	